SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

16 April 2021 · Shift 3

65 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 35 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 25 questions

Q.1

Fill in the blank with most appropriate word. I am sorry to _____ on you at this late hour.

(A) instruct
(B) intrude
(C) interfere
(D) interrupt

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. There was a bell over the door "that jingled whenever" a customer entered.

(A) which jingled wherever
(B) who jingles whenever
(C) No substitution
(D) that jingle when

Q.3

Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word. SPURIOUS

(A) genuine
(B) artificial
(C) counterfeit
(D) phony

Q.4

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. Where did you kept the sack of wheat that I bought from the market?

(A) that I bought
(B) the sack of wheat
(C) Where did you kept
(D) from the market

Q.5

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Facsinate
(B) Obscene
(C) Abscess
(D) Architect

Q.6

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. No version of the origin of California's name has been fully accepted, but there is wide support for the contention that it derived from an early 16th-century Spanish novel. B. California is a constituent state of the United States of America. C. It was admitted as the 31st state of the union on 9 September 1850 and by the early 1960s it was the most populous U.S. state. D. The influence of the Spanish settlers of the 18th and 19th centuries is evident in California's architecture and place-names.

(A) BACD
(B) BCAD
(C) DACB
(D) ADCB

Q.7

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A close-fitting cover for the blade of a knife or sword

(A) Sheath
(B) Shield
(C) Case
(D) Carrier

Q.8

Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. In such places, strong winds blow raising heaps of sand. B. Some deserts are almost totally without water. C. These dunes shift and move endlessly across the desert. D. This sand is deposited in huge mounds called 'sand dunes'.

(A) BADC
(B) DACB
(C) CDBA
(D) BACD

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. Kunal did not anticipate the need, "so he did not carries his own" water bottle.

(A) so he did not carry his own
(B) so he does not carry his own
(C) so he did not carried his own
(D) No substitution required

Q.10

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech. They said that they would issue the certificate the following week.

(A) They said, "They issued the certificate the following week."
(B) They said, "They are issuing the certificate the next week."
(C) They said, "Could we issue the certificate the following week?"
(D) They said, "We will issue the certificate next week."

Q.11

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. The poor washerwoman washes dirty clothes from morning to evening.

(A) Dirty clothes are washed by the poor washerwoman from morning to evening.
(B) Dirty clothes are being washed by the poor washerwoman from morning to evening.
(C) Dirty clothes were washed by the poor washerwoman from morning to evening.
(D) Dirty clothes have been washed by the poor washerwoman from morning to evening.

Q.12

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The team leader asked for a _____ report to be given, in not more than one page.

(A) complex
(B) concise
(C) curt
(D) compound

Q.13

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Pavan returned back home / when he completed / his assignment abroad.

(A) Pavan returned back home
(B) when he completed
(C) his assignment abroad
(D) No error

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. Terrorists kill thousands of innocent people in “cold blood”.

(A) in mountainous areas
(B) by freezing to death
(C) accidentally
(D) cruelly, without any emotions

Q.15

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Hazy

(A) Soft
(B) Clear
(C) Dim
(D) Faint

Q.16

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Novice

(A) Expert
(B) Silent
(C) Beginner
(D) Adept

Q.17

Select the misspelt word.

(A) brutle
(B) cruel
(C) junior
(D) coarse

Q.18

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. DIVULGE

(A) suppress
(B) conceal
(C) reveal
(D) decide

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A sea change

(A) Going on a trip abroad
(B) Getting transferred overseas
(C) Complete transformation
(D) Health-related vacation

Q.20

Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words. a seven-sided figure

(A) hexagon
(B) pentagon
(C) heptagon
(D) octagon

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. I had the train compartment to myself up to Rohana and then a girl got in. The couple who saw her off were (1)_____ her parents. They seemed very anxious (2)_____ her comfort and gave the girl (3)_____ instructions as to where to keep (4)_____ things, when not to lean out and how to (5)_____ speaking to strangers.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(A) probably
(B) likely
(C) absolutely
(D) exactly

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. I had the train compartment to myself up to Rohana and then a girl got in. The couple who saw her off were (1)_____ her parents. They seemed very anxious (2)_____ her comfort and gave the girl (3)_____ instructions as to where to keep (4)_____ things, when not to lean out and how to (5)_____ speaking to strangers.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(A) over
(B) about
(C) during
(D) with

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. I had the train compartment to myself up to Rohana and then a girl got in. The couple who saw her off were (1)_____ her parents. They seemed very anxious (2)_____ her comfort and gave the girl (3)_____ instructions as to where to keep (4)_____ things, when not to lean out and how to (5)_____ speaking to strangers.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(A) dangerous
(B) detailed
(C) diluted
(D) difficult

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. I had the train compartment to myself up to Rohana and then a girl got in. The couple who saw her off were (1)_____ her parents. They seemed very anxious (2)_____ her comfort and gave the girl (3)_____ instructions as to where to keep (4)_____ things, when not to lean out and how to (5)_____ speaking to strangers.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(A) her
(B) their
(C) his
(D) our

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. I had the train compartment to myself up to Rohana and then a girl got in. The couple who saw her off were (1)_____ her parents. They seemed very anxious (2)_____ her comfort and gave the girl (3)_____ instructions as to where to keep (4)_____ things, when not to lean out and how to (5)_____ speaking to strangers.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(A) protest
(B) reject
(C) avoid
(D) protect

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.1

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs to balance the following equation. 40 * 5 * 7 * 24 * 6 * 38

(A) ÷, −, ×, +, =
(B) +, ×, −, ÷, =
(C) +, ×, ÷, −, =
(D) ÷, ×, −, +, =

Q.3

Select the option in which the words share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of words. Rat : Rodent

(A) Frog : Reptile
(B) Cattle : Cow
(C) Whale : Shark
(D) Ostrich : Bird

Q.5

Select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 14, 28, 31, 124, 129, ?

(A) 774
(B) 644
(C) 447
(D) 666

Q.7

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. 122 : 340 : 726

(A) 1886 : 3068 : 4606
(B) 2194 : 3372 : 4910
(C) 2199 : 3377 : 4915
(D) 1951 : 3084 : 4217

Q.8

Two statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some pins are roses. No rose is a machine. Conclusions: I. Some roses are pins. II. Some pins are not machines. III. All machines are pins.

(A) Only conclusions I and III follow
(B) Only conclusion II follows
(C) Only conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.11

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the numbers in the given set. (850, 645, 410)

(A) (558, 256, 356)
(B) (550, 402, 135)
(C) (440, 229, 422)
(D) (751, 396, 544)

Q.12

In a code language, CANDLE is written as FMEOBD. How will FIXING be written in that language?

(A) HOJYKH
(B) FOKYKG
(C) HPJWJG
(D) HOJYJG

Q.13

In a certain code language, LIABILITY is coded as 141 and OFFICIATE is coded as 166. How will STATUTORY be coded in that language?

(A) 87
(B) 159
(C) 156
(D) 81

Q.14

Four letter-clusters have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the letter-cluster that is different.

(A) YWTP
(B) PMJG
(C) MKHD
(D) USPL

Q.15

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the given words in the order in which they appear in an English dictionary. 1. Deceive 2. Deceptive 3. Decapitate 4. Decency 5. Decamp

(A) 4-2-1-3-5
(B) 3-2-1-5-4
(C) 5-3-1-2-4
(D) 5-3-1-4-2

Q.16

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. UDM : YZQ : : QCT : ?

(A) UYK
(B) YGZ
(C) UYX
(D) VZN

Q.17

A father's age at the time of the birth of his son is the same as the present age of the son. If the age of the son was 15 years five years ago, then what is the current age of the father?

(A) 45 years
(B) 40 years
(C) 30 years
(D) 35 years

Q.19

Three of the following four words are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

(A) Applaud
(B) Criticise
(C) Honour
(D) Admire

Q.20

Four numbers have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the number that is different.

(A) 198
(B) 165
(C) 177
(D) 132

Q.21

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of numbers. 263 : 271

(A) 223 : 233
(B) 261 : 267
(C) 317 : 337
(D) 23 : 293

Q.22

'Guitar' is related to 'Music Instrument' in the same way as 'Car' is related to '_____'.

(A) Vehicle
(B) Petrol
(C) Road
(D) Driver

Q.24

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. r r p p s _ p _ s s r _ s s r _ _ p

(A) p r p p s
(B) s r r s p
(C) s s r p p
(D) s p r r p

Q.25

Revati is the sister of Sujit. Pranjal's mother is married to Sujit. Bhavita has one son and one daughter. Lopa is the sister of Pranjal, who is the paternal grandson of Bhavita. Lopa is the daughter of Ramya. How is Revati related to Ramya?

(A) Husband's sister
(B) Brother's wife
(C) Daughter
(D) Sister

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.1

Which of the following states has the highest entrepreneurial activity in the infrastructure sector as per the Economic Survey 2019-20?

(A) Jharkhand
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Sikkim
(D) Karnataka

Q.2

At the 1992 Summer Olympics, _____ became the first woman to carry the flag of India at the opening ceremony of any Olympics.

(A) Karnam Malleswari
(B) Shiny Abraham Wilson
(C) PT Usha
(D) Nilima Ghose

Q.3

Where was the largest solar project namely ‘Provision of Solar Photo Voltaic Powerplant 1.5 MW’ under the ‘Make in India’ initiative set up in November 2020?

(A) Shimla
(B) Leh
(C) Manali
(D) Gulmarg

Q.4

In which of the following states is the Sambhar Lake located?

(A) Punjab
(B) Gujarat
(C) Mizoram
(D) Rajasthan

Q.5

Who is the author of the book 'My Master'?

(A) Swami Vivekananda
(B) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
(C) Sri Aurobindo
(D) Rabindranath Tagore

Q.6

With which of the following sports is Sebastian Korda associated?

(A) Cricket
(B) Badminton
(C) Volleyball
(D) Tennis

Q.7

Who among the following authored the book 'The Great Indian Novel'?

(A) Rohinton Mistry
(B) Vikram Seth
(C) Shashi Tharoor
(D) Khushwant Singh

Q.8

‘Malabar 2020’, a naval exercise conducted in November 2020, saw the participation of _____ country/countries.

(A) two
(B) four
(C) three
(D) one

Q.10

In which of the following states is India's first pollinator park located?

(A) Assam
(B) Uttarakhand
(C) Kerala
(D) Odisha

Q.12
The Chalukya dynasty was a major kingdom in the _____ part of India.

(A) eastern
(B) northern
(C) southern
(D) western

Q.13
Which of the following is NOT a new guideline for credit and debit card users given by Reserve Bank of India in October 2020?

(A) All new credit and debit cards issued by the banks will be only enabled for domestic transactions at ATMs and point of sale (PoS) terminals.
(B) The RBI has asked all the banks to disable online payments for all those debit and credit cards which have never been used for online or contactless transactions.
(C) The RBI said that the debit card and credit card users from now on are allowed to set up their own transaction limits.
(D) None of the card users will have an option to opt-in or opt-out of services on their credit/debit cards.

Q.14
As per 'Soils of India, National Bureau of Soil Survey and Land Use Planning report: Publication Number 94' which type of soil (order) is most abundantly available?

(A) Mollisols
(B) Alfisols
(C) Inceptisols
(D) Aridisols

Q.15
Who is the High Commissioner of India to Bangladesh as of June 2020?

(A) Piyush Goel
(B) Riva Ganguly Das
(C) Narender Batra
(D) Mohammad Mezbah Uddin Chowdhury

Q.16
Who among the following won a silver medal in the women's 57 kg category at the Individual Wrestling World Cup held in Serbia in December 2020?

(A) Aisuluu Tynybekova
(B) Anastasia Nichita
(C) Veronika Chumikova
(D) Anshu Malik

Q.17
GIMP is a/an _____.

(A) application software
(B) diagnostic utility program
(C) text editor
(D) operating system

Q.18
Which of the following festivals is celebrated as a kite-flying festival across India?

(A) Holi
(B) Durga Puja
(C) Janmashtami
(D) Makar Sankranti

Q.19
In which festival of Maharashtra and Chhattisgarh, are the bullocks and other cattles used for agriculture worshipped?

(A) Ganga Dussehra
(B) Pola festival
(C) Vata Poornima
(D) Jiviti Puja

Q.20

Which of the following is a large bean-shaped lymphoid organ in the human body?

(A) Thymus
(B) Spleen
(C) Lymph node
(D) Tonsil

Q.21

A _____ is a software program that travels the web locating and indexing websites for search engines.

(A) bug
(B) spider
(C) python
(D) penguin

Q.22

Which of the following is a variety of oilseed?

(A) Taramira
(B) Arabica
(C) Robusta
(D) Liberica

Q.24

Which of the following Articles of the Constitution of India states that 'The President, or the Governor or Rajpramukh of a State, shall not be answerable to any court for the exercise and performance of the powers and duties of his office'?

(A) Article 396
(B) Article 361
(C) Article 384
(D) Article 352

Q.25

What is the rate at which a wave moves through water, and is measured in knots?

(A) Wave height
(B) Wave crest and trough
(C) Wave frequency
(D) Wave speed

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**
Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**		

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (B) intrude

To 'intrude on' someone is to disturb them without being invited: 'I am sorry to intrude on you at this late hour'. 'Interfere' takes 'in' or 'with', and 'interrupt' takes no preposition.

Q.2 · Answer (C) No substitution

The underlined part is correct: 'that' refers to the bell, 'jingled' keeps the past tense of 'was' and 'entered', and 'whenever' means each time.

Q.3 · Answer (A) genuine

'Spurious' means false or fake; its opposite is 'genuine'. 'Artificial', 'counterfeit' and 'phony' are close to synonyms.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Where did you kept

'Did' is followed by the base form of the verb: 'Where did you keep the sack of wheat'.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Facsinate

The correct spelling is 'fascinate'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) BCAD

B introduces California as a US state, C ('It was admitted') continues its history, A turns to the origin of its name in a Spanish novel and D to the Spanish settlers' influence: BCAD.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Sheath

A sheath is a close-fitting cover for the blade of a knife or sword.

Q.8 · Answer (A) BADC

B introduces deserts without water, A says strong winds there raise heaps of sand, D says 'this sand' forms sand dunes and C says 'these dunes' shift: BADC.

Q.9 · Answer (A) so he did not carry his own

'Did not' is followed by the base form of the verb: 'so he did not carry his own water bottle'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) They said, “We will issue the certificate next week.”

In direct speech the reported 'they would issue' becomes 'We will issue', and 'the following week' becomes 'next week'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Dirty clothes are washed by the poor washerwoman from morning to evening.

The simple present 'washes' becomes 'are washed' in the passive, the plural subject 'dirty clothes' taking 'are'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) concise

A report of not more than one page is 'concise': brief but complete. 'Curt' means rudely brief.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Pavan returned back home

'Return' already means to come back, so 'returned back' is redundant: 'Pavan returned home'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) cruelly, without any emotions

To do something 'in cold blood' is to do it deliberately and cruelly, without emotion.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Clear

'Hazy' means misty or unclear; its opposite is 'clear'. 'Dim' and 'faint' are close to synonyms.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Beginner

A 'novice' is a beginner; 'expert' and 'adept' are its opposites.

Q.17 · Answer (A) brutle

The correct spelling is 'brutal'.

Q.18 · Answer (C) reveal
To 'divulge' is to make known something private: to 'reveal'. 'Suppress' and 'conceal' are its opposites.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Complete transformation
A 'sea change' is a complete or profound transformation.

Q.20 · Answer (C) heptagon
A seven-sided figure is a heptagon; a hexagon has six sides, a pentagon five and an octagon eight.

Q.21 · Answer (A) probably
The narrator only guesses who the couple were: 'probably' her parents. Used alone, 'likely' is normally an adjective ('likely to be her parents'), and 'absolutely' and 'exactly' express certainty.

Q.22 · Answer (B) about
To be 'anxious about' something is to be worried about it: 'anxious about her comfort'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) detailed
The parents gave 'detailed' instructions, covering where to keep things, leaning out and strangers.

Q.24 · Answer (A) her
The girl is told where to keep 'her' things; the possessive refers back to the girl.

Q.25 · Answer (C) avoid
The parents told her how to 'avoid' speaking to strangers.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (D) ÷, ×, −, +, =
$40 \div 5 \times 7 - 24 + 6 = 8 \times 7 - 24 + 6 = 56 - 24 + 6 = 38$.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Ostrich : Bird
A rat is a rodent, and an ostrich is a bird. A frog is an amphibian, not a reptile; a whale is not a shark; and 'Cattle : Cow' reverses the order.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 774
The steps alternate ×2, +3, ×4, +5, ×6: 129 × 6 = 774.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 2194 : 3372 : 4910
Each number is an odd number cubed minus 3: $122 = 5^3 - 3$, $340 = 7^3 - 3$ and $726 = 9^3 - 3$. Likewise $2194 = 13^3 - 3$, $3372 = 15^3 - 3$ and $4910 = 17^3 - 3$.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Only conclusions I and II follow
'Some pins are roses' converts to 'some roses are pins' (I). The pins that are roses cannot be machines, as no rose is a machine, so some pins are not machines (II). Nothing says all machines are pins (III).

Q.11 · Answer (C) (440, 229, 422)
Twice the difference of the first two numbers gives the third: (850 − 645) × 2 = 410. Likewise (440 − 229) × 2 = 422.

Q.12 · Answer (D) HOJYJG
The word is reversed and each letter moved one place forward: CANDLE → ELDNAC → FMEOBD. So FIXING → GNIXIF → HOJYJG.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 81
Each letter takes its position counted from Z (Z = 1, A = 26) and 3 is taken off the total: LIABILITY = 144 − 3 = 141 and OFFICIATE = 169 − 3 = 166. STATUTORY = 8 + 7 + 26 + 7 + 6 + 7 + 12 + 9 + 2 = 84, and 84 − 3 = 81.

Q.14 · Answer (B) PMJG
In YWTP, MKHD and USPL the letters move back 2, 3 and 4 places. In PMJG they move back 3 each time, so it is the odd one.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 5-3-1-4-2
In dictionary order: Decamp (5), Decapitate (3), Deceive (1), Decency (4), Deceptive (2). 'Decam' comes before 'Decap', and 'Decei' before 'Decen' before 'Decep'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) UYX
The letters move +4, −4, +4: U → Y, D → Z, M → Q. Likewise Q → U, C → Y, T → X: UYX.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 40 years
The son is 15 + 5 = 20 now, so the father was 20 when the son was born and is 20 + 20 = 40 now.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Criticise
Applaud, honour and admire all express approval or praise; criticise expresses disapproval.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 177
198, 165 and 132 are multiples of 33 (33 × 6, 33 × 5 and 33 × 4); 177 = 3 × 59 is not.

Q.21 · Answer (C) 317 : 337
263 and 271 are primes with exactly one prime, 269, between them. Likewise only 331 lies between the primes 317 and 337; between 223 and 233 there are two (227 and 229), 261 is not prime, and many primes lie between 23 and 293.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Vehicle
A guitar is a kind of musical instrument, and a car is a kind of vehicle.

Q.24 · Answer (D) s p r r p
With s, p, r, r, p in the blanks the series reads rrppss ppssrr ssrrpp: each block of six moves its first pair to the end.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Husband's sister
Sujit is married to Pranjal's mother, and Pranjal is Bhavita's paternal grandson, so Sujit is Bhavita's son and Revati, his sister, is her daughter. Lopa is Pranjal's sister and Ramya's daughter, so Ramya is Sujit's wife and Revati is her husband's sister.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Jharkhand
The Economic Survey 2019-20 found entrepreneurial activity in the infrastructure sector highest in Jharkhand, Arunachal Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Mizoram, Jammu and Kashmir and Bihar; none of the other options is among them.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Shiny Abraham Wilson
Shiny Abraham Wilson carried India's flag at the opening of the 1992 Barcelona Olympics, the first woman to do so for India.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Leh
A 1.5 MW solar photovoltaic plant built under 'Make in India' was completed at the Indian Air Force station in Leh, Ladakh, in November 2020.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Rajasthan
Sambhar, India's largest inland salt lake, lies in Rajasthan.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Swami Vivekananda
'My Master' is Swami Vivekananda's tribute to his guru, Sri Ramakrishna Paramahamsa.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Tennis
Sebastian Korda is an American tennis player, the son of the Czech player Petr Korda.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Shashi Tharoor
Shashi Tharoor's 'The Great Indian Novel' (1989) retells the Mahabharata as the story of India's freedom movement and its aftermath.

Q.8 · Answer (B) four
Malabar 2020 brought together the navies of India, the United States, Japan and Australia, which rejoined the exercise that year.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Uttarakhand
India's first pollinator park, with plants for bees, butterflies and birds, opened at Haldwani in Uttarakhand in December 2020.

Q.12 · Answer (C) southern
The Chalukyas ruled large parts of southern and central India from the 6th to the 12th century, from Badami, Kalyani and Vengi.

Q.13 · Answer (D) None of the card users will have an option to opt-in or opt-out of services on their credit/debit cards.
Under the RBI's new rules for debit and credit cards, in force from 2020, users can opt in or out of online, international and contactless use and set their own transaction limits; so the claim that no user may opt in or out is not one of them.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Inceptisols
By that report, used in NCERT's soil table, Inceptisols cover about 40% of India, the largest share of any order, well ahead of Alfisols, Aridisols and Mollisols.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Riva Ganguly Das
Riva Ganguly Das was India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh from 2019 to October 2020.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Anshu Malik
India's Anshu Malik took silver in the women's 57 kg at the Individual World Cup in Belgrade in December 2020, losing the final to Moldova's Anastasia Nichita.

Q.17 · Answer (A) application software
GIMP (GNU Image Manipulation Program) is a free image-editing program: application software.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Makar Sankranti
Makar Sankranti, in mid-January, is marked by kite flying across India, above all in Gujarat, where it is called Uttarayan.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Pola festival
At Pola, farmers in Maharashtra and Chhattisgarh bathe, decorate and worship their bullocks.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Spleen
NCERT describes the spleen as a large bean-shaped organ, made up mainly of lymphocytes and phagocytes. Lymph nodes are bean-shaped too, but small.

Q.21 · Answer (B) spider
A spider, or web crawler, visits web pages and follows their links, indexing them for a search engine.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Taramira
Taramira (Eruca sativa) is an oilseed crop. Arabica, Robusta and Liberica are varieties of coffee.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Article 361
Article 361 protects the President and the Governor (or, until the office was abolished in 1956, the Rajpramukh) of a State from being answerable to any court for acts done in their office.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Wave speed
Wave speed is how fast a wave moves through water, often given in knots at sea. Wave height is the vertical distance from trough to crest, and wave frequency the number of waves passing a point in a given time.

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